KCC CODE CLUB · GAME MAKERS

Week 8

Polish, Test and Showcase

Week 8 of 8

Name _____

Today's big idea

Finishing is a skill. Making something work for *you* is one thing. Making it work for someone who has never seen it before is completely different — and much harder.

The three debugging rules

Write these somewhere you'll remember them. They work on code, homework, and arguments.

1. **Say what you expected and what actually happened.** Half of all bugs are found in that one sentence.
2. **Change one thing at a time.** If you change three things and it works, you don't know which one fixed it.
3. **Explain it out loud.** To a friend, to a volunteer, or to a rubber duck. You'll usually spot it halfway through your own sentence.

Playtest Swap

Move two seats to the right. Play the game in front of you for five minutes. **Don't ask the person who made it any questions** — if you're confused, that's useful information.

Fill this in for the game you played:

Game I played: ____

Two things I liked:

1. _____
2. _____

One thing that confused me:

One thing I'd add:

> **When you get your card back: you're not allowed to defend your game.** Just read it and say thank you. If it confused them, it confused them — that's the whole point of testing.

Finishing checklist

Work down this list. **Don't add anything new today** — polish what you have.

- [ ] **Title screen** with the game's name and your name
- [ ] **Instructions** — one line. "Use the arrow keys to catch the mangoes."
- [ ] **Score and lives** visible and easy to read
- [ ] **Game over screen** showing your final score
- [ ] **At least one sound**
- [ ] **Credits** — your name and the club
- [ ] Fixed whatever the playtest turned up
- [ ] **Shared** to the club studio

Sharing safely

Your project will be visible to anyone in the world. So:

- **Don't** put your full name, your school, your address, or a photo of yourself in it.
- Comments are public. **Be kind.** If someone is unkind to you, don't argue back — report it and tell a grown-up.
- If you used someone else's sprite, sound or idea, **say so in your credits**. Remixing is encouraged on Scratch. Pretending it's all yours isn't.

Your two-minute demo, at the showcase

1. What your game is, in one sentence.
2. Play it for thirty seconds.
3. **The hardest bug you fixed and how you found it.** ← this is the best bit, don't skip it

My hardest bug was:

No homework. Instead — keep going!

Where to find more free projects:

- More Scratch — the natural next step
- Further Scratch — clones, My Blocks, boolean logic
- Code Club Aotearoa — hundreds of free projects
- The club studio — see what everyone else built, and remix it

Five ideas for the holidays:

1. A two-player Sky Catcher — one on arrows, one on WASD
2. A quiz about something you love
3. An animated version of a story you know
4. A drawing app using the Pen extension

5. A "guess the number" game where the computer picks and you guess

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You built a game. From nothing. In eight weeks.

That's a real thing that you made, and it will still work in ten years. Well done.

Stuck? Put your hand up — that is what we are here for. And always save before you close the lid.